SHIELD-AI

A Sovereign Australian Framework for Secure Agentic AI

Security Architecture Practice • July 2026

The Agentic AI Security Challenge

Australian enterprises are deploying AI agents that can **act autonomously** — not just chatbots, but systems that:

78%
of AU enterprises deploying or piloting AI agents (ASD 2026)

63%
say existing security frameworks don't cover agentic AI

12h
SOCI Act reporting window — too fast for unprepared teams

THE GAP IS WIDENING

Agentic AI adoption is accelerating faster than security capability. Every month of delay increases exposure.

⚠️

"We didn't know the agent was compromised until the regulator called"

— Head of Security at an Australian financial institution, speaking anonymously at AusCERT 2026

7 weeks	**12 hours**	**$2.2M**
before detection	SOCI reporting window	max penalty per obligation

Agentic AI creates a detection gap that traditional security monitoring cannot close.

This is what SHIELD-AI prevents.

Why Existing Frameworks Aren't Enough

Framework	Agentic AI Gap
ISM (1,081 controls)	No AI-specific controls
Essential Eight	Designed for commodity malware
NIST CSF / ISO 27001	No coverage of prompt injection, tool delegation, agent identity
OWASP LLM Top 10	Threat taxonomy, not a control framework
NIST AI RMF	Risk management, not implementable controls

THE RESULT

Organisations face a **compliance gap**: they meet their ISM/E8 obligations on paper but have no defensible position for agentic AI risk.

SHIELD-AI FILLS THIS GAP

Built from the ground up for Australian regulatory frameworks and agentic AI-specific threats.

Australian Regulatory Imperative

Your obligations don't stop at traditional infosec — every Australian framework now intersects with AI:

ASD ISM (1,081 CONTROLS)

"Guidelines for secure AI system development" — March 2026 edition

ESSENTIAL EIGHT (×3 MATURITY)

Application control, patching, MFA — all must extend to AI agents

SOCI ACT

12-hour mandatory incident reporting for critical infrastructure

APRA CPS 234

Board accountability for information security — including AI

PRIVACY ACT 1988 (APPS)

APP 11: Security of personal information — breached by insecure AI

AU MANDATORY GUARDRAILS

Proposed legislation for high-risk AI — expected 2027-28

SHIELD-AI Framework

Six pillars covering the full agentic AI lifecycle

PILLAR 1

Model Security

Model weights, supply chain, adversarial robustness

PILLAR 2

Identity & Access

Agent identity, scope-bound delegation, human oversight

PILLAR 3

Data Security

Classification, minimisation, memory sanitisation

PILLAR 4

Tool & Pipeline

Tool registry, API gateway, pipeline integrity

PILLAR 5

Monitoring & IR

Behavioural detection, mandatory reporting, forensics

PILLAR 6

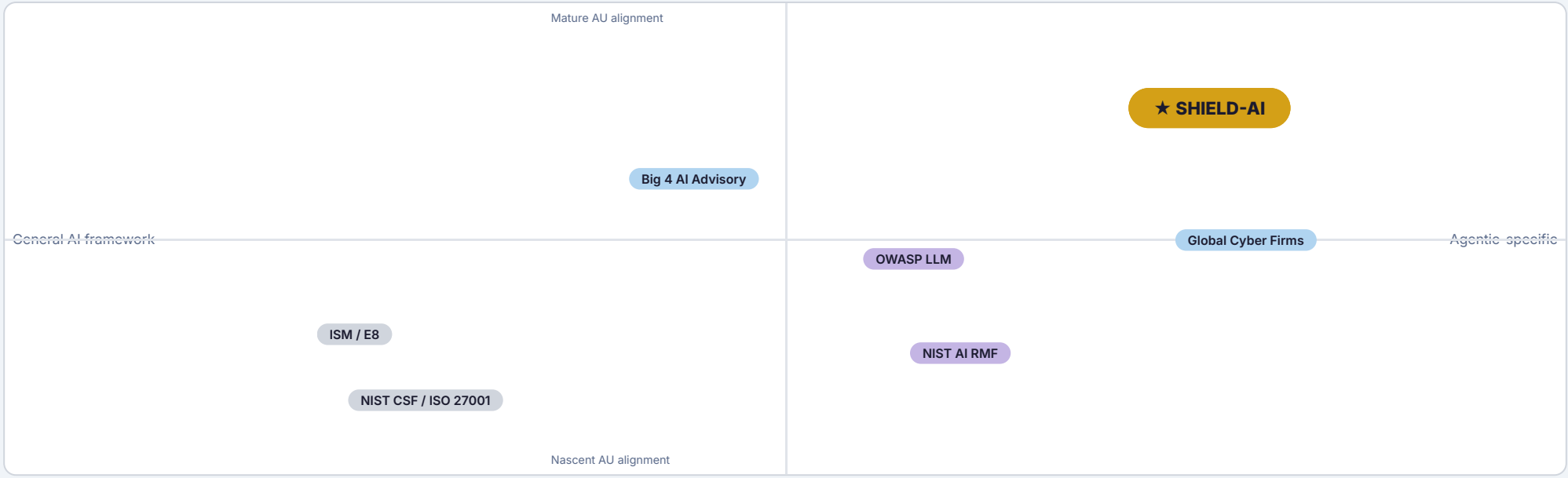
Governance & Risk

AI risk register, board reporting, compliance automation

Cloud-agnostic · LLM-agnostic · Industry-agnostic · Sovereign Australian

Why SHIELD-AI?

Positioned to dominate — agentic-specific controls with mature AU regulatory alignment



★ **SHIELD-AI** — Only framework in the top-right: agentic-specific + AU mature. Everyone else covers only one dimension.

Your SHIELD-AI Journey

Four maturity levels — no organisation starts at L4

Level	Name	Description	Typical Client
L1	Initial	Basic controls, no formal governance	AI experimenters, PoCs
L2	Managed	Documented controls, basic monitoring	SMEs, early adopters
L3	Defined	Automated controls, regulatory mapped	Regulated entities, government
L4	Optimised	Continuous improvement, red-teaming	Critical infrastructure, national security

"We meet you where you are and build from there."

The Business Case

Cost of inaction vs. cost of mitigation

Risk Scenario	Cost of Inaction	SHIELD-AI Cost
AI exfiltrates customer PII	$1.78M avg (OAIC 2025) + regulatory action + reputation damage	$25K–$120K Lite / Standard
Prompt injection causes financial loss	Loss amount × agent transaction limit + brand damage	$120K–$250K Standard
SOCI-reportable incident	Penalties up to $2.2M per obligation + public notification	$250K–$400K Standard + assurance
APRA regulator inquiry	Enforcement action + remediation costs	$120K–$250K Standard + regulatory
Board liability for AI harm	Director duty of care + civil penalties	$120K–$250K Standard + governance

Service Offering

Three engagement tiers — scalable to your needs

LITE

$25–45K

AI security posture assessment
Regulatory exposure report
30/60/90-day action plan
Board summary briefing

2-3 weeks

STANDARD

$120–250K

Full 6-pillar gap assessment
Control implementation
Regulatory mapping report
Agentic AI security architecture
6-month assurance programme

12-16 weeks + assurance

ENTERPRISE

$400–800K+/yr

Everything in Standard, plus:
Embedded AI security architect
Continuous red-teaming
AI threat intelligence feed
Cross-entity governance

Ongoing strategic partnership

How We Deliver

1 2 3 4 5

Discover
Weeks 1-2
Inventory & regulatory map

Assess
Weeks 3-4
Gap analysis & maturity score

Design
Weeks 5-8
Target architecture & roadmap

Implement
Weeks 9-16
Controls, policies, integration

Assure
Ongoing
Reviews, monitoring, updates

What a SHIELD-AI Client Gets

AFTER LITE ($25-45K)

You know what agentic AI risks you have, which regulatory obligations apply, what to fix first — and whether you need Standard.

AFTER STANDARD ($120-250K)

Agentic AI at Maturity Level 3. Auditable regulatory compliance. Ongoing assurance without hiring full-time AI security specialists.

AFTER YEAR 1 ENTERPRISE ($400K+/YR)

Maturity Level 4. Industry-leading posture. Regulatory confidence for audit and examination. Strategic advantage over peers.

Major Australian Bank (Standard)

"Zero AI controls to L3 in 14 weeks. Regulator asked for AI security posture — we sent the SHIELD-AI compliance dashboard."

Federal Government Agency (Lite → Standard)

"Lite found 60% of AI pilots had no access controls. Standard closed every finding. First AI deployment passed Gate Review."

Insurer (Enterprise — Year 1)

"Continuous red-teaming caught a prompt injection our SOC missed. The embedded architect saved us 3 months of ramp-up time."

All case studies available under NDA • Names sanitised

Next Steps

1. INITIAL CONSULTATION (30 MINUTES)

We assess your current AI posture, regulatory obligations, and readiness for a SHIELD-AI engagement.

2. LITE ENGAGEMENT SCOPING

If appropriate, we scope a 2-3 week SHIELD-AI Lite assessment tailored to your environment and regulatory context.

3. POSTURE ASSESSMENT DELIVERED

You receive your AI security posture assessment, regulatory exposure report, and prioritised action plan.

4. DECISION POINT

Based on findings, you decide: continue to Standard for full implementation, or address priority items internally with our roadmap.

Contact: practice-lead@consultancy.example.com

SHIELD-AI — In 90 Seconds

SHIELD-AI is Australia's sovereign security framework for organisations deploying autonomous AI agents — systems that act, not just chat.

The problem: Existing frameworks (ISM, E8, NIST) don't cover AI-specific threats like prompt injection, tool delegation abuse, or autonomous decision-making. Yet ASIC, APRA, OAIC, and the government's proposed mandatory AI guardrails all expect regulated entities to demonstrate AI security.

The solution: 36 controls across 6 pillars at 4 maturity levels. Every control maps to specific ISM control IDs, E8 descriptors, SOCI obligations, CPS 234 criteria, and Privacy Act requirements.

The business case: Cost of inaction (breach costs $1.78M avg + penalties up to $2.2M + reputation) vs SHIELD-AI investment ($25K Lite to $120-250K Standard). 3:1 to 70:1 ROI depending on tier and risk scenario.

Next step: A 30-minute exploratory conversation. No commitment beyond the conversation. You walk away knowing your AI security posture and regulatory exposure.

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